Aalto University
School of Science
Department of Computer Science

Working Title of the Doctoral Thesis

Subtitle, if any

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DOCTORAL THESES
Draft of 19th October 2026. Replace these pages with initials/initials.pdf.

Abstract

Problem: the gap in knowledge this thesis addresses. Aim and research questions. Data and methods. Main findings of the publications and how they fit together. Contribution to the discipline. At most one page.

Keywords: keyword one, keyword two, keyword three

Tiivistelmä

Tiivistelmä suomeksi. Yksi sivu enintään.

Avainsanat: avainsana yksi, avainsana kaksi

Preface

Acknowledgements to the supervising professor, advisors, pre-examiners, opponent, co-authors, funders, colleagues and others.

Espoo, 19th October 2026

Akira Taguchi

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List of publications

This thesis consists of an overview and of the following publications, which are referred to in the text by their Roman numerals.

I Akira Taguchi and Co-Author Name. Title of the first article. *Journal Name, volume(issue), pages, 2027. DOI: 10.xxxx/xxxxx.*

II Akira Taguchi. Title of the second article. *Submitted to Journal Name, 2027.*

III Akira Taguchi, Co-Author Name and Supervisor Name. Title of the third article. *Manuscript, 2028.*

Author's contribution

Publication I I designed the study, collected and analysed the data, and wrote the manuscript. Co-Author Name contributed to the research design and revised the manuscript.

Publication II I am the sole author of this publication.

Publication III I led the research design, collected the data and wrote most of the manuscript. Co-Author Name carried out the quantitative analysis. Supervisor Name contributed to the framing and revised the manuscript.

Abbreviations

EU	European Union
RQ	Research question

1 Introduction

1.1 Background and motivation

The phenomenon, why it matters now, and for whom. Example citations: digital platforms as private governors of markets (Lehdonvirta 2022), time and flexibility in online piecework (Lehdonvirta 2018), measuring the online gig economy (Kässi and Lehdonvirta 2018).

1.2 Research problem and questions

The gap in existing research, stated as one problem.

RQ1 First research question, answered mainly in Publication I.

RQ2 Second research question, answered mainly in Publication II.

RQ3 Third research question, answered mainly in Publication III.

1.3 Contributions

The thesis's specific scientific contribution, in a few sentences. The pre-examiners and the opponent look for it here.

1.4 Structure of the thesis

Chapter 2 reviews … Chapter 3 describes … Chapter 4 summarises the publications. Chapter 5 integrates the findings, and Chapter 6 concludes.

2 Theoretical background

2.1 Key concepts

Definitions the publications rely on, stated once here.

2.2 Prior research

The literatures the thesis speaks to, and what each leaves open.

2.3 Analytical framework

How the concepts fit together to frame the three publications.

3 Research design and methods

3.1 Overall design

Why this combination of studies answers the research problem.

3.2 Data

Table 3.1: Data and methods by publication.

Publication	Data	Method
I	Interviews ($n = \ldots$)	Qualitative analysis
II	Platform records	Regression analysis
III	Policy documents	Document analysis

3.3 Methods

Analysis procedures, with the detail left to the publications.

3.4 Research ethics and data management

Ethical review, consent, anonymisation, data storage and sharing.

4 Summary of the publications

4.1 Publication I: First article

Aim, data and methods, main findings, and the answer to RQ1.

4.2 Publication II: Second article

Aim, data and methods, main findings, and the answer to RQ2.

4.3 Publication III: Third article

Aim, data and methods, main findings, and the answer to RQ3.

5 Discussion

5.1 Integrating the findings

What the publications show together that none shows alone. This is the argument of the thesis as a whole.

5.2 Theoretical contributions

5.3 Implications for policy and practice

5.4 Limitations

5.5 Future research

6 Conclusion

The answer to the research problem in one or two pages, and the significance of the thesis for the discipline.

Bibliography

Kässi, Otto and Vili Lehdonvirta (2018). 'Online Labour Index: Measuring the Online Gig Economy for Policy and Research'. In: *Technological Forecasting and Social Change* 137, pp. 241–248. DOI: 10.1016/j.techfore.2018.07.056.

Lehdonvirta, Vili (2018). 'Flexibility in the Gig Economy: Managing Time on Three Online Piecework Platforms'. In: *New Technology, Work and Employment* 33.1, pp. 13–29. DOI: 10.1111/ntwe.12102.

Lehdonvirta, Vili (2022). *Cloud Empires. How Digital Platforms Are Overtaking the State and How We Can Regain Control*. Cambridge, MA: The MIT Press. DOI: 10.7551/mitpress/14219.001.0001.

Publications

Publication I: First article

Akira Taguchi and Co-Author Name. Title of the first article. *Journal Name, volume(issue), pages, 2027. DOI: 10.xxxx/xxxxx.*

Placeholder. Save the article as publications/I.pdf to include it here.

Publication II: Second article

Akira Taguchi. Title of the second article. *Submitted to Journal Name, 2027.*

Placeholder. Save the article as publications/II.pdf to include it here.

Publication III: Third article

Akira Taguchi, Co-Author Name and Supervisor Name. Title of the third article. *Manuscript, 2028*.

Placeholder. Save the article as publications/III.pdf to include it here.